gerrymandering plaintiff must "disentangle race from politics and prove that the former drove a district's lines"). That is true regardless whether the case is brought pursuant to the Fourteenth Amendment or the VRA, since § 2 of the VRA requires evidence giving rise to a strong inference of intentional discrimination. If race and politics are not disentangled and a § 2 claim is cynically used as a tool for advancing a partisan end, the VRA's noble goal will be perverted.

Third, while the dissent wraps itself in the mantle of *stare decisis*, the dissent is unabashedly at war with key precedents. See *post*, at 170 (claiming that *Rucho* was disastrously wrong and should be cabined); *post*, at 132, 134–135, 168 (repeatedly criticizing *Shelby County* and citing the dissent in that case); *post*, at 130–131 (criticizing the Court's decision in *Brnovich*). Respect for precedent cannot be a one-way street.

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The judgment of the District Court is affirmed, and these cases are remanded for proceedings consistent with this opinion.

It is so ordered.

JUSTICE THOMAS, with whom JUSTICE GORSUCH joins, concurring.

I join the Court's opinion in full. This Court should never have interpreted § 2 of the Voting Rights Act of 1965 to effectively give racial groups "an entitlement to roughly proportional representation." *Thornburg* v. *Gingles*, 478 U. S. 30, 93 (1986) (O'Connor, J., concurring in judgment); see *ante*, at 113–114. By doing so, the Court led legislatures and courts to "systematically divid[e] the country into electoral districts along racial lines." *Holder* v. *Hall*, 512 U. S. 874, 905 (1994) (THOMAS, J., concurring in judgment). "Blacks [we]re drawn into 'black districts' and given 'black representatives'; Hispanics [we]re drawn into Hispanic districts and given

'Hispanic representatives'; and so on." *Ibid.* That interpretation rendered §2 "repugnant to any nation that strives for the ideal of a color-blind Constitution." *Id.*, at 905–906. Today's decision should largely put an end to this "disastrous misadventure" in voting-rights jurisprudence. *Id.*, at 893.

As I explained more than 30 years ago, I would go further and hold that §2 of the Voting Rights Act does not regulate districting at all. See *id.*, at 922–923. The relevant text prohibits States from imposing or applying a "voting qualification," "prerequisite to voting," or "standard, practice, or procedure," in a manner that results in a denial or abridgement of the right to vote based on race. 52 U. S. C. §10301(a). How States draw district lines does not fall within any of those three categories. *Holder*, 512 U. S., at 922–923 (opinion of THOMAS, J.); *Allen* v. *Milligan*, 599 U. S. 1, 46 (2023) (THOMAS, J., dissenting). The words in §2 instead "reach only 'enactments that regulate citizens' access to the ballot or the processes for counting a ballot'; they 'do not include a State's . . . choice of one districting scheme over another.'" 599 U. S., at 46 (quoting *Holder*, 512 U. S., at 945 (opinion of THOMAS, J.)). Therefore, no §2 challenge to districting should ever succeed.

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JUSTICE KAGAN, with whom JUSTICE SOTOMAYOR and JUSTICE JACKSON join, dissenting.

Consider the story of a hypothetical congressional district in a hypothetical State, subjected to a redistricting scheme. The example is admittedly stylized, but in its essence simulates the dispute before us, and clarifies the immense issues at stake. The district, let's say, is a single county, in the shape of a near-perfect circle, sitting in the middle of a rectangular State. The State is one with a long history of virulent racial discrimination, and its many effects, including in residential segregation and political division, remain significant even today. The population of the circle district is 90% Black; the rest of the State, divided into five surrounding